

Eureka Dubai — Judge Q&A; Preparation

8 Categories · 20+ Questions with Evidence-Based Answers

Q&A; PREPARATION

Classification: Competition Preparation — Confidential

Date: February 19, 2026

Purpose: Anticipated judge questions with prepared, honest, evidence-based answers

Audience: Harold Nunes — internal preparation only

CATEGORY 1: TRACTION & CUSTOMERS

Q: "Do you have any paying customers?"

Answer:

"Not yet — and that's intentional. We've spent the last 3 months validating the governance engine in the hardest domain first: real-time financial markets. 670,000+ evaluation cycles, 98.5% capital preserved. The engine works. Now we're ready for enterprise pilots."

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"Our first 3 target clients are prop trading firms in ADGM/DIFC — we've identified 200+ in the ecosystem. The \$500K raise funds the transition from validated product to paying enterprise clients within 3-6 months."

Key framing: Discipline, not delay. You validated before selling — that's institutional credibility.

Q: "What's your revenue?"

Answer:

"Pre-revenue. Our Year 1 target is \$200K-\$400K from 3 enterprise pilots at \$15K-\$35K/month. We chose to validate the engine before monetizing — the same discipline the product enforces."

Q: "670,000 decisions — but how many of those are real trades vs. simulations?"

Answer:

"670,000 are real governance evaluation cycles — every 60 seconds, the engine evaluates market conditions through all 6 checkpoints. 119 were actual trade executions during calibration. 47 were correctly blocked. The governance engine runs 24/7 regardless of whether a trade is placed — that's the data that trains the system."

CATEGORY 2: SOLO FOUNDER

Q: "You're a solo founder — can you really execute on this?"

Answer:

"I built the entire system — governance engine, AI orchestration, post-quantum security, production infrastructure — solo, using AI as a force multiplier. Lean architecture designed for scalability; AI-assisted development reduces burn while maintaining velocity."

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The product already runs 24/7 in production. The hard part is done. The \$500K raise includes hiring 3 key people — Senior Backend Engineer, DevOps, and Business Development — to scale what already works. Not to build what doesn't."

Follow-up if pressed: "Amazon started solo. Dell started solo. The question isn't team size — it's execution capacity. The product exists. It runs. It has data. That's execution."

Q: "What if you get hit by a bus?" / "How do you mitigate key-person risk?"

Answer:

"Excellent question — and it's exactly what the first \$500K resolves. The mitigation plan has 3 layers:

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Layer 1 — Documentation & Defensive Architecture (Already Done) *The codebase is built with hexagonal architecture and domain-agnostic patterns — not artisanal code that only I understand. 27 Architectural Decision Records, full traceability matrices, and operational runbooks are version-controlled in the repository. A senior engineer can onboard in 2-3 weeks, not months. And the system already runs 24/7 autonomously — it doesn't require manual intervention to operate.*

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Layer 2 — First Hires (Months 1-4 Post-Investment) - Senior Backend Engineer (Month 1-2): absorbs knowledge of the core engine - DevOps/Infrastructure (Month 2-3): makes operations founder-independent - Business Development (Month 3-4): distributes commercial responsibility

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With these 2-3 hires, founder dependency drops from 100% to approximately 30%.

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Layer 3 — Structural Protections (Months 3-6) - Formal IP assignment to the company (not the founder) - Operational runbooks for every critical process - Key-person insurance as part of the operating budget - Cross-training protocols so no single person holds exclusive knowledge

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But I want to be honest: today I am a single point of failure, and that's precisely why I'm raising capital. Objective #1 of the funding is not just product — it's eliminating this risk by building the core team in the first 4 months."

Key framing: Acknowledge the risk honestly (investors detect evasion). Show that mitigation is already partially in place (architecture, autonomous system). Connect the use of capital directly to solving this risk. Give a concrete timeline (4 months, not "eventually").

Follow-up if pressed: "The system has been running 24/7 for 3+ months with zero manual intervention for core operation. The hard dependency isn't keeping the system alive — it's evolving and selling it. That's what the hires solve."

Q: "OMNIX is 100% dependent on you. If you retire or something happens, our regional partners lose support. How do you mitigate this critical operational risk in the first 6 months?"

Answer:

"You're right — and I take this seriously. Here's the 6-month operational risk elimination plan:

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Month 1-2: Senior Backend Engineer hired. Full knowledge transfer of core engine. Pair programming on all critical modules. This person can independently operate and extend the system by Month 3.

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Month 2-3: DevOps/Infrastructure engineer hired. Production infrastructure documented and transferred. Deployment, monitoring, and incident response no longer depend on the founder.

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Month 3-4: Business Development hired. Commercial relationships and partner management distributed. IP formally assigned to the company.

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Month 4-6: Key-person insurance active. Operational runbooks complete for all critical processes. Cross-training validated — at least 2 people can handle any critical function.

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By Month 6: Founder dependency reduced from 100% to ~20% (strategic direction and product vision only). The system operates, scales, and serves partners independently of any single person.

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The architecture was designed for this — hexagonal, modular, documented. It's not spaghetti code that only I understand. It's infrastructure built to be operated by a team."

Key framing: This is the detailed operational version for investors who probe deeper. Show concrete month-by-month dependency reduction with measurable outcomes.

CATEGORY 3: BUSINESS MODEL

Q: "Why would a prop firm pay \$15K-\$35K/month for this?"

Answer:

"Because a single bad drawdown event costs them \$50K-\$200K. OMNIX reduces severe drawdown frequency by an estimated 40%. At \$25K/month, the ROI is 2-8x their monthly cost — just from losses avoided.

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More importantly, regulations like MiCA are making governance infrastructure mandatory. Firms need audit trails and decision governance documentation. Building this in-house costs \$500K+ and takes 12-18 months. We offer it as plug-and-play infrastructure."

Q: "Your pricing seems high for pre-seed — have you validated it?"

Answer:

"The pricing is benchmarked against what prop firms currently pay for risk infrastructure. Riskalyze charges \$20K-\$50K/month for portfolio risk analytics. Our pricing sits at the lower end of institutional risk infrastructure.

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But the real validation comes from pilots — which is exactly what the funding enables. We'll start with discounted pilots at \$10K-\$15K/month and move to full pricing after proving ROI."

Q: "How do you get from \$0 to 3 enterprise clients?"

Answer:

"Three channels: 1. **Direct outreach** — 200+ prop firms registered in ADGM/DIFC. We target 50/month with personalized governance assessments. 2. **Regulatory pull** — MiCA compliance deadline is creating urgent demand. We position as the fastest path to decision governance documentation. 3. **Event networking** — Eureka Dubai is literally our first channel. TOKEN2049, FinTech Abu Dhabi, ADGM Innovation Hub events.

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The enterprise sales cycle is 3-6 months: assessment → shadow mode (2-4 weeks) → advisory mode → enforcement mode → paid license."

CATEGORY 4: COMPETITION

Q: "Who are your competitors?"

Answer:

"Nobody does exactly what we do — that's the category creation opportunity. But adjacent competitors exist in 4 categories:

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1. **Retail trading bots** (3Commas, Cryptohopper) — they optimize for action. We optimize for restraint. Different product category. 2. **Risk analytics platforms** (Riskalyze, BarraOne) — they report risk after trades. We validate before execution. 3. **Internal quant fund tools** — only available inside \$100M+ hedge funds. We make governance accessible. 4. **RegTech compliance** (Chainalysis, Elliptic) — they monitor transactions. We govern decision quality.

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The real competitor is doing nothing — firms managing risk with spreadsheets and manual oversight."

Q: "What stops a well-funded player from copying this?"

Answer:

"Three things: 1. **Data moat** — 670,000+ evaluation cycle events. The Shadow Portfolio learns from decisions the system doesn't make. You can't replicate that dataset without running the engine for months. 2. **Architecture moat** — 6-checkpoint sequential validation with fail-closed behavior isn't trivial to build. We have 27 Architectural Decision Records documenting every design choice. 3. **Embedded infrastructure** — once a prop firm integrates OMNIX into their execution flow, switching cost is high. Re-integration, re-calibration, re-certification.

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Plus, we're filing 3 patent families to protect the core IP."

CATEGORY 5: MARKET & SCALABILITY

Q: "How big is the actual addressable market?"

Answer:

"First vertical — digital asset trading: 200+ prop firms in ADGM/DIFC alone, 2,000+ platforms needing MiCA compliance globally. Conservative Year 1 target: 3 clients. That's not ambitious — it's disciplined."

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Multi-vertical expansion doubles the TAM every year: credit risk (\$7.4B), supply chain (\$3.2B), insurance (\$5.1B). Combined addressable market: \$37B+. But we don't need to win the whole market — 15-30 enterprise clients at \$25K/month puts us at \$3M-\$6M ARR."

Q: "The multi-vertical story sounds nice — but can you really do credit and insurance?"

Answer:

"We already built interactive governance demos for credit and insurance — live on our website right now. The same 6-checkpoint architecture evaluates a loan applicant or an insurance policy with different inputs but identical governance logic."

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In trading, checkpoint 1 runs Monte Carlo simulations. In credit, it calculates default probability. Different signal, same checkpoint structure. That's what 'domain-agnostic' means — and it's not theoretical, it's demonstrable."

Q: "What's your international expansion plan?"

Answer:

"ADGM Dubai first — that's the beachhead. MiCA compliance creates pull across Europe in Year 2. Asia (Singapore, Hong Kong) in Year 3."

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The expansion follows regulatory demand. When new jurisdictions mandate decision governance, we're already built for it."

CATEGORY 6: UNIT ECONOMICS

Q: "What are your unit economics?"

Answer:

*"Enterprise B2B: - **ACV**: \$180K-\$360K/year per enterprise client - **CAC**: \$15K-\$30K (direct sales, 3-6 month cycle) - **LTV**: \$540K-\$1M+ (3+ year retention — infrastructure lock-in) - **LTV:CAC**: 18:1 to 33:1 - **Gross margin**: 60-70%*

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These are projections based on industry benchmarks for B2B infrastructure. Real validation comes with the first 3 pilots."

Q: "When do you break even?"

Answer:

"Month 10-12 in our base case scenario. With \$500K and monthly costs around \$40K, we have 18+ months of runway. One enterprise client at \$25K/month covers 60% of operating costs. Three clients and we're cash-flow positive."

CATEGORY 7: TECHNOLOGY

Q: "What's special about your AI? Everyone has AI now."

Answer:

"We don't sell AI. We sell governance. The AI is a component — we orchestrate 3 providers (Gemini, GPT-4o, Claude) so there's zero single-provider dependency. If one goes down, the system continues."

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What's special is the 6-checkpoint architecture: Monte Carlo simulation, risk limits, signal agreement, trend confirmation, stress testing, and logic contradiction detection — all running in sequence, all with veto authority. Most systems have 1 risk check. We have 6 independent ones that must ALL agree."

Q: "Most AI systems are black boxes that regulators can't approve. How does OMNIX guarantee explainability and traceability?"

Answer:

"This is exactly why we built OMNIX the way we did. Explainability isn't a feature we added later — it IS the architecture. Three pillars:

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Pillar 1 — Decision Trace (Full Audit Per Decision) Every decision OMNIX makes — executed OR blocked — generates a complete structured record with: exact timestamp, all 6 checkpoints evaluated with individual verdicts and the data that justified each one, the final decision with specific reasoning, and the capital preserved or committed.

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No black box. A compliance officer can open any decision from the last 3 months and see exactly WHY the system acted or stopped. 670,000+ of these traces exist today.

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Pillar 2 — Fail-Closed Architecture = Explainability by Design In a black box, the system acts and then you try to explain why. In OMNIX, the system does NOT act until 6 independent checkpoints approve. Each checkpoint is individually explainable: - 'Win probability was 48.7% — below the 50% threshold' - 'Only 3 of 5 models agreed — insufficient consensus at 44% vs 45% required' - 'Trend did not persist for 3 consecutive cycles'

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It's never 'the algorithm decided.' It's 'checkpoint 3 failed because consensus was 44% against the threshold of 45%.' Every number, every threshold, every verdict — visible and verifiable.

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Pillar 3 — Compliance Officer Toolkit - Decision Trace export: Structured JSON, ready for regulatory audit submission - **Post-quantum signatures:** Every decision signed with NIST-standardized post-quantum algorithms — immutable, tamper-proof, and verifiable - **Shadow Portfolio:** Not just what was decided, but what WOULD HAVE happened with a different decision — counterfactual evidence - **27 documented ADRs:** Every architecture decision has formal justification

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An ADGM regulator can request the trace for any decision from the last quarter, and we deliver it in minutes — not weeks."

Key framing: Contrast with "black box" AI directly. Give concrete numeric examples (48.7%, 44% vs 45%). Mention NIST-standardized post-quantum cryptography — resonates with compliance officers. Close with "minutes, not weeks" — operational readiness.

Follow-up if pressed on regulatory readiness: "We're not claiming compliance certification today — that requires ADGM formal review. What we're saying is: every piece of data a regulator would need already exists, is structured, and is exportable. That's a 12-month head start on any competitor building this from scratch."

Q: "What tools do you give a compliance officer so they sleep well at night?"

Answer:

"Four specific deliverables:

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*1. **Decision Audit Dashboard** — Real-time view of all governance decisions with drill-down into each checkpoint. Filter by time, decision type (executed/blocked), or risk level.*

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*2. **Exportable Decision Traces** — Every decision as structured JSON with complete checkpoint data, timestamps, and rationale. Compatible with Grafana, Loki, ELK, or any audit platform.*

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*3. **Immutable Signatures** — Every governance decision is cryptographically signed with NIST-standardized post-quantum algorithms. No one — including us — can alter a decision record after the fact.*

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*4. **Counterfactual Evidence** — The Shadow Portfolio shows what would have happened if the system **HAD** executed a blocked decision. This proves governance value with hard numbers, not estimates.*

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The compliance officer doesn't have to trust OMNIX. They have to verify OMNIX. And we give them every tool to do exactly that."

Key framing: "Trust vs verify" is the key distinction. Most AI asks for trust. OMNIX provides verification tools.

Q: "Why post-quantum cryptography? Isn't that overkill?"

Answer:

"We sign every decision with NIST-standardized post-quantum cryptography. It's operational since November 2025, not on a roadmap. For institutional clients managing \$5M-\$500M, quantum-resistant audit trails aren't overkill — they're future-proofing their compliance documentation. It's also a competitive moat: no competitor in our category has this."

CATEGORY 8: VALUATION & FUNDING

Q: "Why is this worth \$2.5M-\$3M pre-money?"

Answer:

"Working product in production for 3+ months. 670,000+ evaluation cycle events. Defensible IP. Filed-ready patent families. Interactive demos across 3 verticals. All built by one person with zero burn."

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Chainalysis raised at \$4M pre-money at a comparable stage. The MENA seed median is \$18.9M (MAGNiTT 2024). At \$2.5M-\$3M, this is conservative pricing for validated infrastructure."

Q: "How will you use the \$500K?"

Answer:

"35% — Risk engine refinement and multi-vertical expansion. 25% — ADGM legal and regulatory structure. 20% — Enterprise API infrastructure. 15% — 3 key hires (backend, devops, business development). 5% — Reserve."

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Capital preservation extends to your capital too. No flashy office, no marketing burn. Infrastructure, team, and regulatory structure."

DELIVERY NOTES

General Rules for All Answers

- 1. Lead with numbers** — every answer starts with a concrete metric when possible
- 2. Acknowledge honestly** — "Not yet" is stronger than deflection
- 3. Reframe to strength** — solo = capital-efficient, pre-revenue = disciplined, no customers = validated-before-selling
- 4. End with the next step** — every answer closes with what happens next
- 5. Never oversell** — use "conservative", "benchmarked", "validated in" — not "revolutionary", "game-changing", "disruptive"

Body Language Notes

- Pause before numbers — let them land
 - "Fail-closed" = slight pause after, this is the differentiator
 - "670,000+" = say slowly, make eye contact
 - Don't rush the solo founder answer — own it with confidence
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OMNIX — Governing decisions under uncertainty.

Eureka Dubai 2026 — Semifinalist

